

HERITAGE CONSERVATION, INSTITUTIONS AND UNESCO

Indian Art and Culture Topic 14 - corrected conceptual spine - checked 6 Sep 2026

1. CATEGORY FIREWALL

- Tangible -> movable / immovable / cultural / natural / mixed
- Intangible -> living practice / performance / craftsmanship / festival
- Documentary -> manuscript / archive / record
- GI -> UNESCO category

2. CONSERVATION GRAMMAR

- Conservation = stabilise and retain fabric
- Restoration = selected earlier phase, higher authenticity risk
- Reconstruction = rebuilt loss, highest caution
- Adaptive reuse = new use without loss of significance / setting / fabric

3. UNESCO PROGRAMME MAP

- World Heritage 1972 -> criteria -> advisory bodies -> management -> danger-list logic
- ICH 2003 -> Representative / Urgent / Good Practices
- Memory of the World -> documentary heritage
- Current anchors: Moidams 2024, Maratha 2025, Sarnath 2026, Deepavali 2025

4. LAW AND INSTITUTIONS

- Art 49 -> State duty
- Art 51A(f) -> citizen duty
- AMASR 1955 + 2010 -> central monuments / control zones
- Antiquities Act 1972 -> antiquities / export control
- ASI, NMA, Ministry, state archaeology, INTACH, IGNCA, NMMA, NMM, National Museum

5. THREAT -> TOOL

- erosion / climate -> monitoring, drainage, site plan
- tourism / roads / urban pressure -> setting, access, amenities
- trafficking -> provenance, records, Antiquities Act
- weak transmission -> safeguarding, practitioner support, community role

6. CURRENT-STATUS DISCIPLINE

- Heritage conservation is a complex process involving multiple stakeholders and disciplines. It requires a holistic approach that considers the physical, cultural, and social aspects of heritage. The process involves identifying, assessing, and managing heritage resources, and implementing measures to protect and preserve them for future generations.

7. DIRECT ANSWER ROUTE

- Start with category, not rhetoric.
- Then state the mechanism of loss: erosion, crowd pressure, encroachment, trafficking or weak transmission.
- Then match the tool: law, institution, documentation or community safeguarding.
- Then close with one dated current anchor and one bounded limitation.
- Best 2018 thesis: Safeguarding is a present need because present pressures are differentiated, and monuments, living traditions, documentary records and antiquities need different tools.